

Dutch and German expressionism

With parallels in German contemporary art, expressionist architecture emerged through the ideas of Bruno Taut (1880–1938) and Hans Poelzig (1869–1936) as a counter to the formalism, rational planning and pure geometries of the Deutscher Werkbund and modernism. The movement spread across Europe after being taken up by the Dutch, Austrian, Czech and Danish avant-garde from 1910 to 1930.

Characterized by distortion, emotional ideas, sculptural forms and organic or biomorphic shapes, expressionism also took inspiration from new technical possibilities offered by mass-produced brick, steel and glass. Taut's Glass Pavilion (1914), a pointed dome of coloured panes, was a temporary construction for a Werkbund exhibition in Cologne. Economic constraints limited the number of commissions built between 1914 and 1925, and many expressionist works remained as drawings. The term now encompasses architecture of any date or location that exhibits qualities of the original movement.



***Hufeisensiedlung* (Horseshoe Estate) in Berlin, Taut, 1925–33**